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No word on \$50k reward for Brown tipster

As neighbors laud man for his actions, he opts to lay low

By Steph Machado and Alexa Gagosz
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — On a chilly Saturday afternoon in December, John noticed someone out of place. Inside Brown University's Barus

and Holley building, an unfamiliar man stood out. He was dressed for the wrong season, wearing a jacket too light for the weather. John followed him out of the academic building and confronted him, mentally logging details that would soon prove to be critical.

The man turned out to be Claudio Manuel Neves Valente, who hours later would shoot and kill Ella Cook and MukhammadAziz Umurzokov and wound nine of their class-

mates in a mass shooting that left the community reeling.

John, an Ivy League graduate who has described himself as homeless and whom police only identified by his first name, would become a key witness in ending the frantic six-day manhunt that followed. He posted about the encounter on Reddit, later relaying to police a description of Valente's clothing and rental car, helping to lead investigators to a storage unit in New Hampshire

where the shooter was found dead by suicide. An official said John "blew the case right open."

A month later, despite John being the person most credited with helping unravel the mystery, there's been no clear word on whether he will get a \$50,000 reward initially offered by the FBI during the hunt — or any other lasting support.

Across Providence, neighbors, Brown community members, and

BROWN, Page A7

US says it's sorry for deporting student

Admits violating court order; next step unclear

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

In a potentially dramatic development in the case of a Babson College freshman who was abruptly deported over Thanksgiving, federal authorities on Tuesday acknowledged they were wrong to expel her in violation of a court order.

The court admission was an unusual show of contrition during the Trump administration's aggressive campaign to swiftly deport immigrants. But it's unclear whether it will immediately lead to Any Lucia Lopez Belloza, 19, being able to return from Honduras.

The federal judge in the court proceeding Tuesday, Richard G. Stearns, prodded lawyers for the administration to find a way to let Lopez Belloza return to the United States and remain here legally.

Her deportation, Stearns said, was a "tragic case of bureaucracy going wrong. It might not be anybody's fault, but she was the victim of it."

Lopez Belloza was on her way home to Texas to surprise her parents and sisters on Thanksgiving when she was arrested at Logan Airport. As has become a hallmark of the administration's immigration push, authorities shuffled her between locations and then out of state.

Because it was unclear where she was, her attorney at the time filed for her release in Massachusetts. On the day after Thanksgiving, another federal judge in Boston ordered the administration to

DEPORTED, Page A6



PHOTOS BY CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

For years, Harvard reinforced its commitment to DEI, but had to revamp its admissions process after a Supreme Court ruling.

STUDENTS FEAR HARVARD IS GIVING IN ON DEI

Changes leave some feeling abandoned as school negotiates with Trump



In 2023, students protested after the affirmative action ruling.

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

For months, Harvard has fought to preserve the image of a university that stands up to President Trump, accruing small wins as it took on the federal government in court to defend its research funding and international students.

But there is one area where the school has indicated it is willing to make concessions: diversity, equity, and inclusion.

Harvard and the Trump administration are negotiating behind closed doors as the federal government demands the university make changes to areas such as admissions decisions and faculty hiring. Before any deal has been struck, however, the university made changes including merging centers aimed at minority students, women, and LGBTQ students into one "Office of Culture and Community"; combining a recruitment program focused on attaining students of color with others; changing how student leaders are trained and identify themselves to peers; and altering campus signage rules, removing a prominent Black Lives Matter banner.

The moves alarmed some students who worry the uni-

HARVARD, Page A7

Healey and challengers divided over state of state

By Samantha J. Gross and Matt Stout
GLOBE STAFF

To hear Republicans tell it, Massachusetts residents are living through an economic nightmare. Energy bills are strangling household budgets. The average resident can't afford to buy a home here. Squeezed by costs, one in three voters says they've considered leaving the state entirely.

As she runs for reelection this year, Governor Maura Healey is presenting a far sunnier vision of Massachusetts: It's business-friendly and the best place to raise a family. No state has a better economy, according to one report her office has touted; no place is more "environmentally friendly," claims another.

"There's no better place to live than Massachusetts!" Healey cheered in one fund-raising missive celebrating the state's ranking at the top of a Wallathub list.

Whether Healey wins reelection this fall — or falls to one of the three Republicans challenging her — could hinge on which version of the state that voters feel they're living in. Is it the still-thriving Massachusetts that leads the country in "education, health care, innovation, and for working

ECONOMY, Page A6

Roxbury angered as city moves on with parcel

Instead of affordable housing, lab space, it may become site of vocational school

By Catherine Carlock
GLOBE STAFF

The Wu administration plans to kill a long-planned laboratory and affordable housing project on city-owned land on Tremont Street in Roxbury and will instead consider building a new Madison Park vocational high school on the site, which has been dormant for a half-century.

The abrupt reversal, disclosed at a community meeting Monday night, closes another chapter of failed attempts to redevelop the 8-acre parcel across from the headquarters of the Police Department. It also dashes the dreams of residents

of seeing a potentially powerful economic generator, with prized jobs in the much vaunted life-sciences sector, and much-needed affordable homes come to a part of the city long starved for both.

While the idea of a new high school campus is also welcome, it is not what the neighborhood had been promised — "2,710 good-paying jobs with long-term career tracks," according to its developers, as well as "a commitment to job training in the life sciences industry for those in the Roxbury community."

The announcement trig-

HIGH SCHOOL, Page A10



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

The neighborhood had been promised "2,710 good-paying jobs with long-term career tracks," according to its developers.



Hats off

Wednesday: Sprinkles, mild. High 47-52. Low 38-43.

Thursday: More of the same. High 44-49. Low 16-21.

Sunrise: 7:11. Sunset: 4:35

Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C9.

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Six federal prosecutors in Minnesota resigned over the Justice Department's push to investigate the widow of a woman killed by an ICE agent. **A2.**

Massachusetts continues to suffer through one of the worst influenza seasons in recent memory, despite seeing a slight dip in cases. **B1.**

Inflation cooled a bit as prices for gas and used cars fell, a sign that stubbornly elevated cost pressures are slowly easing. **B5.**

Food writer Devra First checks out Cafe Sushi Nisei, which has been reborn numerous times. **G1.**

The Red Sox rebuffed Alex Bregman on his wish for a no-trade clause. **C1.**